PROJECT DOCUMENTATION

StoryCast

Semantic HTML · Sass · Grid, Flexbox & container queries · WCAG 2.1 AA · Aime Ndayambaje · October 2026
Repository: github.com/<username>/storycast

1. Overview

StoryCast is a 3-page microsite (Home, Story detail, About & Access) presenting three video stories from young Rwandans, each with a corrected, timestamped transcript. It uses no frameworks: hand-written HTML5, Sass compiled to one CSS file, and about 60 lines of vanilla JavaScript for progressive enhancement.

2. Project structure

```
storycast/
├── index.html · about.html
├── story/            bahati-satir.html · yvan-munyengango.html · vanessa-mutesi.html
├── sass/             main.scss + abstracts/ base/ layout/ components/ utilities/
├── css/main.css      compiled output
├── js/main.js        menu toggle · transcript toggle · click-to-seek
├── assets/           video/ audio/ images/ transcripts/ (.vtt + .txt)
└── docs/             research.pdf · documentation.pdf · sitemap.png
```

3. Semantic structure

- Every page has `header` → `nav` → `main` → `footer`, with a skip link to `#main` first.
- Story pages: `article` (breadcrumb `nav` with `ol`, `header` with H1 and a `dl` of facts, `figure` + `figcaption`, transcript `section` with an `ol`) and an `aside` for related stories.
- Story cards are `article`s inside a `ul`; lengths use `time datetime="PT3M11S"`; the mission quote is a `blockquote`; the contact is an `address`.
- One H1 per page; H2 for sections, H3 for cards. No skipped levels on any page.

4. Sass architecture

Folder	Files	Purpose
`abstracts/`	`_colors`, `_typography`, `_spacing`, `_mixins`	Design tokens and mixins (`respond()`, `focus-ring`, `visually-hidden`, `imigongo()`). Output no CSS.
`base/`	`_layers`, `_reset`, `_base`	Layer order, reset, element defaults
`layout/`	`_layout`	Container, header, footer, all grids
`components/`	`_nav`, `_button`, `_hero`, `_media-card`, `_story`, `_feature`	BEM blocks
`utilities/`	`_a11y`	Skip link, visually-hidden

Tokens

Raw palette values are mapped to **semantic tokens** (`$color-primary`, `$color-text-muted`…), and components only use the semantic names. Spacing uses one 4px-based scale (`$space-1` – `$space-8`), and type sizes are fluid with `clamp()`.

Cascade layers

```
@layer reset, base, layout, components, utilities;   /* base/_layers.scss */

@layer components {          /* every partial wraps its rules in one layer */
  .media-card { ... }
}
```

A later layer always wins regardless of selector specificity, so utilities such as `.visually-hidden` override components without `!important`, and component styles never fight the reset.

BEM

Blocks: `.media-card`, `.player`, `.transcript`, `.story-meta`, `.nav`… Elements: `.media-card__thumb`, `.transcript__time`. Modifiers: `.button--outline`, `.media-card__thumb--sky`, `.story-grid__item--featured`, `.transcript--flush`. Partials use `@use` modules, not the deprecated `@import`.

5. Responsive design

- **Mobile-first** with two breakpoints (48rem, 64rem) through the `respond()` mixin.
- **Grid:** story grid `repeat(auto-fit, minmax(min(100%, 24rem), 1fr))` with the featured item spanning `1 / -1`; content + 20rem sidebar on story pages; 2fr 1fr 1fr footer.
- **Flexbox:** header, nav, button groups, card metadata, transcript header.

Container query: `.media-card`

```
.story-grid__item, .story-layout__aside { container: card / inline-size; }

@container card (min-width: 36rem) { .media-card { flex-direction: row; } }   /* horizontal */
@container card (max-width: 21rem) { .media-card__thumb { flex: 0 0 5rem; } } /* compact */
```

Where the card is	Container width	Layout
Featured story (home, desktop)	~72rem	Horizontal
Story grid (home, desktop)	~35rem	Stacked
Story grid (tablet)	~44rem	Horizontal
"More stories" sidebar	20rem	Compact

The same markup changes based on the space it is given, not the screen width.

6. Accessibility checklist

Requirement	Implementation
Captions	`<track kind="captions" srclang="en" default>` → `storycast-intro.vtt`; YouTube embeds use `cc_load_policy=1`
Transcripts	On-page timestamped transcript for every story and the audio intro, plus a .txt download; estimated timestamps are labelled
Media descriptions	`figure` / `figcaption` linked with `aria-describedby`; titled iframes; fallback download links
Keyboard	Skip link; native controls; one link per card (`::after` overlay); Escape closes the menu; focusable scroll region
Focus	3px `:focus-visible` outline (sky) with offset; `:focus-within` on cards; yellow on the dark footer
Contrast	Text 15.7:1 · muted 7.0:1 · links 6.1:1 · button 6.5:1 · footer 10.9:1 · lowest 5.6:1
ARIA (only where needed)	`aria-expanded` / `aria-controls` (menu, transcript); `aria-current="page"`; `aria-label` on navs, regions, timestamp buttons; `aria-hidden` on decorative SVGs
Motion	`prefers-reduced-motion` removes transitions, hover lifts and smooth scroll; no autoplay
No-JS	Menu falls back to a visible list; transcripts are visible by default

7. Testing

- **Automated:** axe-core 4.10 (WCAG 2.0/2.1 A + AA + best practice) reports 0 violations on all 5 pages.

- **Keyboard:** the first Tab lands on the skip link; the mobile menu opens and closes and Escape closes it; the transcript toggle updates `aria-expanded` and its label.
- **Links:** every internal link and in-page anchor resolves; no duplicate IDs; heading order checked on every page.
- **Layout:** no horizontal scroll at 390px or 1280px; container-query states checked in the grid, the featured card and the sidebar.

8. Running locally

```
git clone https://github.com//storycast.git && cd storycast
python -m http.server 8000          # or VS Code → Live Server
# open http://localhost:8000

npm install -g sass
sass --watch sass/main.scss css/main.css   # recompile after editing Sass
```

9. Credits

Story videos belong to their creators and are embedded from YouTube: PinedaFoundation (Bahati Satir, 2012), theoisback (Yvan Munyengango, 2020), and the ITU Telecom World 2015 interview (Vanessa Mutesi). Transcripts were corrected by the author. The intro narration was generated with eSpeak NG. Fonts are from Google Fonts.